



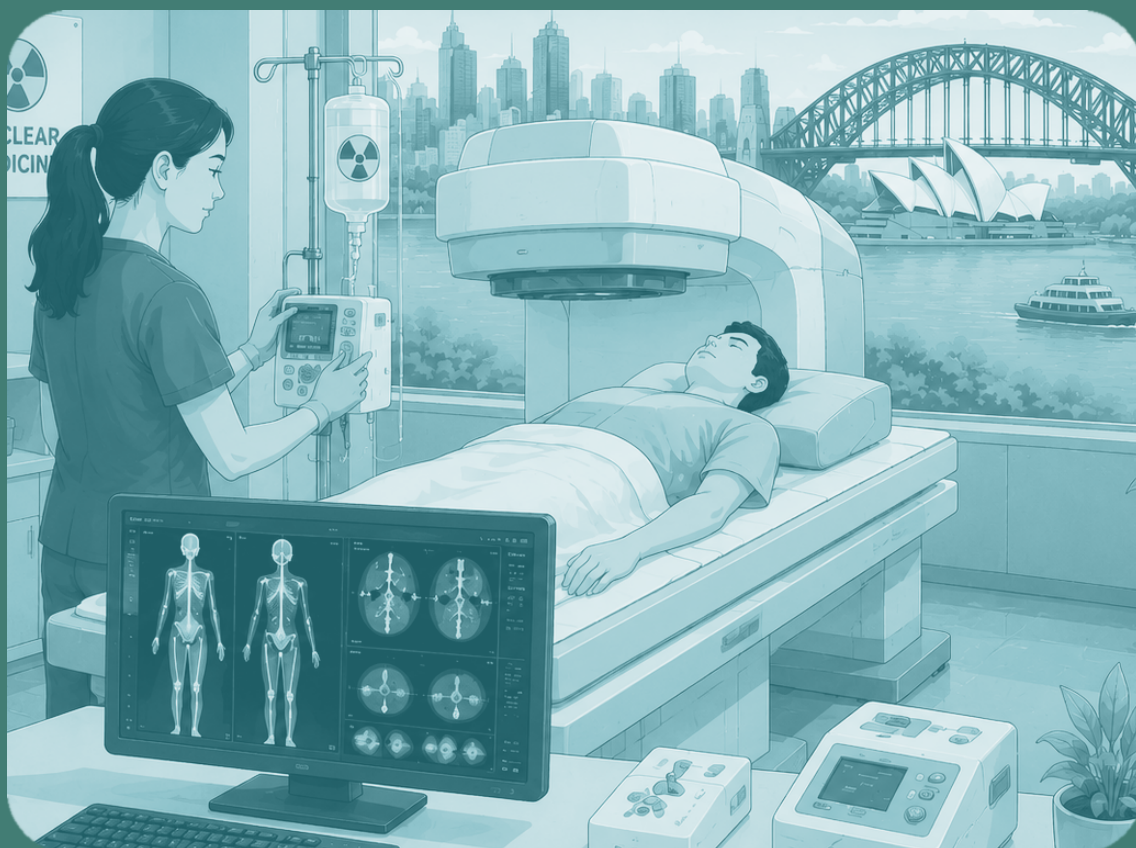
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Nuclear Medicine Technologist Registration Guide

Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (Ahpra)

Your complete guide to registering as a nuclear medicine technologist in Australia — MRPBA registration, explained in plain English for internationally qualified practitioners.



WELCOME

Welcome to your registration guide

For an internationally qualified nuclear medicine technologist, the credential that lets you practise in Australia is registration with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA), through Ahpra. Nuclear medicine technologist is a protected title under the National Law, so you must hold registration before you can work.

Nuclear medicine sits a little differently from diagnostic radiography and radiation therapy. The UK (HCPC) and Ireland (CORU) comparable-regulator lists that fast-track radiographers and radiation therapists do not cover nuclear medicine, so most overseas nuclear medicine qualifications go through individual assessment. There is also a second, separate process — a migration skills assessment — which for nuclear medicine technologists is carried out by the ANZSNM, not ASMIRT, and which comes after registration rather than before it.

How to use this guide

Read it once from start to finish to understand the shape of the journey, then keep it nearby and return to each section as you reach it. It's a handbook, not a leaflet.

An important note. This guide complements, not replaces, the official guidance published by the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia. The Board sets the rules and makes all registration decisions; where there is ever any difference, the Board's own published requirements always take precedence. Ethicare supports and guides you — and, as your recruitment partner, helps secure the role and sponsorship — but we do not make registration decisions on the Board's behalf.

What's inside

01 Understanding the Board & the scope

02 Registration vs migration — and the order

03 Is your qualification recognised?

04 Qualification assessment

05 English language

06 The national MRP examination

07 Your supporting documents

08 Applying, licensing & starting

SECTION 01

Understanding the Board & the scope

The Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia (MRPBA), through Ahpra, registers diagnostic radiographers, radiation therapists and nuclear medicine technologists. Its role is to protect the public by ensuring practitioners are suitably trained, qualified and safe to practise.

Nuclear medicine technologist is one of three separate divisions, each with its own registration. You register specifically in the nuclear medicine technologist division — a single registration does not let you practise across divisions.

Two things are separate and you need both: MRPBA registration (which lets you practise) and, in most states, a state radiation use licence (which lets you operate radiation equipment and handle unsealed radioactive materials). They are issued by different bodies.

Registration lets you practise; a state radiation use licence lets you use radiation. You need both.

SECTION 02

Registration vs migration — and the order

Two processes run in parallel but are entirely separate: registration with the MRPBA, and — for certain skilled-migration visas — a migration skills assessment. Success in one does not guarantee the other.

For nuclear medicine technologists the migration skills assessment is carried out by the Australian and New Zealand Society of Nuclear Medicine (ANZSNM), the gazetted assessing authority — not ASMIRT, which assesses radiographers and radiation therapists.

The order is important: nuclear medicine technologists generally obtain MRPBA registration first, then apply to ANZSNM for the migration skills assessment. On an employer-sponsored visa you may not need a skills assessment at all — confirm your visa route with your employer or a registered migration adviser.

Lead with MRPBA registration. The ANZSNM skills assessment, where a visa needs it, comes afterwards.

SECTION 03

Is your qualification recognised?

The Board recognises a qualification it considers substantially equivalent to an approved Australian qualification. For nuclear medicine, the recognised-qualifications list is short and specific — it must match the institution, qualification title and award year exactly — so most overseas applicants will need an individual assessment rather than relying on the list.

The HCPC (UK) and CORU (Ireland) comparable-regulator routes apply to radiographers and radiation therapists, not to nuclear medicine — so they are generally not a fast lane for this division.

If your qualification isn't on the recognised list, there are two routes: an individual assessment of your qualification against the Australian standard, or — if you hold a relevant qualification in a division of registration — demonstrating you've passed the Canadian (CAMRT) certification exam or the New Zealand (NZMRTB) exam. Check the current position on the Board's 'Is my qualification recognised' page.

Start with the Board's qualification check — for nuclear medicine, individual assessment is the usual route.

SECTION 04

Qualification assessment

Where the Board assesses your qualification, it looks at whether your program is substantially equivalent to, or based on similar competencies as, an approved Australian nuclear medicine technology qualification.

Expect it to weigh the educational level (comparable, at minimum, to an Australian Bachelor degree), the accreditation and quality assurance of your program, and whether the core nuclear-medicine competencies are covered — radiopharmacy and radiation safety, instrumentation and imaging (including SPECT/CT and PET/CT), and clinical practice.

If there are gaps, the outcome may direct you to the national MRP examination or to supervised practice before general registration. The assessment is individual, so a complete, well-evidenced submission matters.

The Board checks equivalence to the Australian nuclear-medicine standard — evidence your competencies clearly.

SECTION 05

English language

All applicants must meet the Board's English Language Skills Registration Standard. If English isn't your first language, or your training wasn't taught and assessed entirely in English, you'll provide an approved test result.

Requirements and accepted tests are reviewed periodically, so confirm the current accepted tests, scores and any exemptions against the Board's English-language standard before booking anything.

Time any test so the result is still valid when your application reaches the Board — sitting it too early risks it expiring before you submit.

Meet the Board's English standard; confirm the current tests and exemptions before booking.

SECTION 06

The national MRP examination

Depending on your assessment outcome, you may need to sit the National Medical Radiation Practice examination before general registration. Not every applicant sits it — it depends on how your qualification is assessed.

Where it applies, expect content set in the Australian context — radiation safety legislation, the Board's professional capabilities, and cultural safety — alongside profession-specific knowledge for nuclear medicine. It's held several times a year.

Confirm whether the exam applies to you as part of your assessment outcome, and prepare against the Board's published exam reading and resources list.

Whether you sit the national exam depends on your assessment — confirm it early and prepare in context.

SECTION 07

Your supporting documents

A clean, certified documentation pack is the single biggest factor within your control on timing. You'll generally assemble certified proof of identity (with evidence of any name change), your nuclear medicine qualification and full academic transcript, and evidence of supervised clinical training where required.

You'll also need your registration history and a Certificate of Good Standing from each authority you're registered with (current), an up-to-date CV detailing roles, dates and responsibilities, and certified translations of any non-English documents supplied with the certified original.

Present it like a professional portfolio: certified copies (not copies of certified copies), clean high-resolution scans, and consistent naming. A well-organised application is assessed faster than a disorganised one containing exactly the same facts.

Certify it correctly the first time and keep the pack consistent — organisation drives timing.

SECTION 08

Applying, licensing & starting

You apply to Ahpra / the MRPBA using the relevant application form, selecting the nuclear medicine technologist division, and pay the application/registration fee (non-refundable — confirm current figures on the Board's fees page). Respond promptly to any Board queries; incomplete applications are the most common cause of delay.

Once registration is granted you're cleared to practise, but in most states you must also obtain a state radiation use licence before operating equipment or handling unsealed radioactive materials — licensed separately by each state or territory.

Many Australian employers expect registration to be in place (or well underway) before you start. As a matter of good practice, don't make irreversible moves — resigning or relocating — until your registration eligibility is confirmed.

Register with the MRPBA, add your state radiation licence, then start — in that order.

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to navigate this alone

If you choose to partner with Ethicare, we'll support you from first enquiry through securing your nuclear medicine role, MRPBA registration and relocation to your first day at work — with a single point of contact, honest guidance, and help at every stage. We support and guide you through the process; the registration decision always rests with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia.

READY TO BEGIN?

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